

Chapter 97-1

A person who had always been refined and cultured wouldn't know how to curse.

Just like Liang Shi—the dirtiest words she had ever said were "trash" and "disgusting." So when she encountered what this woman said, she only felt her blood rush straight to her head. She wanted to curse back but didn't know what to say.

She could only stand in front of Ling Dang to protect her, looking at the woman with cold eyes.

Xu Qingzhu was also stunned for a second. Surprisingly, the first one to react was Sheng Yu. With a bandage on her forehead, she said arrogantly, "You ugly freak! Who are you yelling at?!"

The woman was taken aback. After a moment, she sneered, "Well, well! You actually brought a bunch of people here! Let me tell you! You little mutt—if anything happens to my son, I absolutely won't let you off!"

"Shut up!"

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu shouted simultaneously, their voices carrying a chilling severity.

The office fell silent in an instant. The woman's face also showed an expression of shock, as if she hadn't expected the adults on the other side to talk back.

Moreover, she unconsciously shivered, intimidated by the aura of the two.

But after a moment, she shouted again, "What? You think you can bully me with more people? Let me tell you—if my son dies, I'll tear her to pieces too! Little mutt!"

Ling Dang shrank back. Liang Shi reached out and covered Ling Dang's ears.

Xu Qingzhu stood there, her brow furrowing tighter and tighter. She said coldly, "Are you done yet?"

The woman wasn't as tall as Xu Qingzhu. When their eyes met, she was already at a significant disadvantage in terms of presence—not to mention Xu Qingzhu's piercing cold eyes.

The woman avoided meeting Xu Qingzhu's gaze and continued arrogantly, "What? She can do it but I can't say it? This little sl—"

"Slap—"

Xu Qingzhu's palm landed on the woman's face with a crisp sound, cutting off her words mid-sentence.

Xu Qingzhu didn't know how to curse either, and she certainly couldn't stoop to trading vulgar insults with this woman in front of children. But she was truly furious.

Liang Shi had already told her—Ling Dang had cried for a day and a night because of this incident. Such a cheerful child normally, now she was timid and hesitant about everything.

What's more, there were two children standing here, both raised with care and affection. Who had ever suffered such humiliation?

"Shut up." Xu Qingzhu withdrew her tingling palm and said coldly, "If there's something wrong with your son and it's determined to be our responsibility, we're willing to bear the corresponding consequences no matter what it takes. But right now, please shut up and stop barking like a mad dog in front of children."

The woman's face quickly turned red. She opened her mouth wanting to curse, but her mind went blank for a moment.

She had never expected the other party would slap her directly.

Clearly they were the ones who had done wrong, and she had just said a few words.....

How..... how dare they?!

Only after Xu Qingzhu finished speaking did the woman come back to her senses. "You..... you actually hit me? I'll f***ing beat you to death....."

After saying that, she swung her hand wildly at Xu Qingzhu like a madwoman. Xu Qingzhu stepped back half a step and instinctively raised her arm to block, but then someone pulled her body back.

In a flash, Liang Shi's hand grabbed the woman's arm, suppressing her with absolute strength. Under her grip, the woman's hand gradually curled up like a chicken claw, and her facial expression became twisted. "You! Let go of me! You're bullying me with numbers! I..... I'm calling the police!"

"Fine." Liang Shi released her hand. "Go ahead."

The woman shook her numb wrist. "Dr. Shen, you saw it just now—they struck first. You have to testify for me later."

Shen Hui had already taken off her white coat. The doctor taking over her night shift had also arrived and was standing at the door in an awkward position.

Generally speaking, doctors didn't want to get involved in any kind of conflict. They were afraid that one wrong word would lead to a doctor-patient dispute.

As an eternally relevant topic in the medical field, any doctor who got involved in a doctor-patient dispute would face a lot of trouble.

Unless something truly unavoidable happened, doctors wouldn't get involved in this kind of situation.

They just wanted these people to leave the hospital quickly—whether they wanted to fight or argue, take it all outside!

Shen Hui removed her mask, her hair falling loose around her shoulders. A dark wool coat was casually draped over her arm. She looked at the woman coldly. "It seems your son's condition isn't serious. I'm off work now. If you need anything, find Dr. Han."

Dr. Han, standing at the door looking completely confused and not knowing what had happened: "?"

"No, Dr. Shen." The woman panicked. "My son is really serious. He has a high fever, almost 39 degrees."

Shen Hui said coldly, "I'm off work."

The woman turned to the newly arrived doctor. This one was more senior and had been at the hospital longer. She rolled up her sleeves and walked into the office, saying coldly, "If it's serious, why do you have time to argue in the office? It's already this late, and many children are asleep. What are you trying to do by causing trouble here?"

The woman immediately said, "I'm sorry, I'm sorry. It's all because of these little mutts....."

Before she could finish, pain shot through her knees and she dropped directly to the ground.

Liang Shi stood beside her, her expression cold. Her light brown pupils looked like they were coated with a layer of frost that wouldn't melt. "If you still don't know how to speak properly, I don't mind teaching you."

The woman finally showed some fear, but she said stubbornly, "Just you wait! I'm calling the police! This is intentional assault!"

Liang Shi directly took out her phone, dialed 110, and handed it to her. "Hurry up. I'm waiting."

The woman had only been talking tough—she had never actually intended to do it.

When the call connected, a deep male voice came through on speakerphone: "Hello, this is the Haizhou City Public Security Bureau. What happened?"

The woman immediately fell silent. She hurriedly stood up and made a show of brushing the dust off her knees, but said nothing.

Liang Shi raised an eyebrow at her, with a provocative look—Go on, call the police. Say something.

The woman still didn't budge. After a while, the voice on the other end asked again. Seeing that the woman wasn't going to speak, Liang Shi brought the phone to her ear. "Hello, officer. I'd like to report something."

Everyone in the office turned to look at Liang Shi in unison.

They heard Liang Shi say coldly, "I assaulted someone. Serious injury. We're currently at the children's hospital. The other party is unwilling to settle this privately."

"Alright, I'll wait here." Liang Shi finished speaking and hung up.

Then she handed the phone to Xu Qingzhu and called out to Shen Hui. "Dr. Shen, could you please go check on that boy with the fever? We don't want anything to actually happen to him."

Xu Qingzhu tugged at her clothes and asked in a low voice, "What are you going to do?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She paused for a moment. "I can't hold back anymore."

"Ling Dang, Sheng Yu." Liang Shi called out to them. "Close your eyes."

Sheng Yu reached out and covered Ling Dang's eyes, and then Ling Dang covered Sheng Yu's eyes.

The woman suddenly panicked. "You..... what are you going to do? Breaking the law knowingly adds to the crime....."

Before she could finish, Liang Shi grabbed her shoulders and executed an over-the-shoulder throw. Then Liang Shi twisted her arm, making her scream in pain.

Liang Shi said coldly, "Shut up."

The woman screamed, "She's hitting me!"

Xu Qingzhu went directly to close the door, then moved to cover the two children's ears.

In the spacious office, Liang Shi's knee pressed against the woman's back. "Do you know how to speak properly? I've already called the police for you. I hope you'll learn to speak like a human being in the future."

Then she landed a punch on the woman's waist and abdomen.

For self-protection, Liang Shi had trained in Muay Thai, Sanda¹, and Taekwondo. Her training was quite varied, but her strength was considerable.

Especially when she had filmed medical dramas before, the production crew had people come specifically to instruct her. She had learned some things that weren't usually useful—like where to hit to cause a lot of pain without injuring vital areas or leaving particularly serious wounds.

Now she was putting that knowledge to use.

Footnotes:

¹ **Sanda (散打)**: Also known as Sanshou, this is a Chinese martial art and combat sport. It combines elements of traditional kung fu with modern combat techniques, including punches, kicks, throws, and takedowns. It was developed by the Chinese military and is now practiced as both a competitive sport and for self-defense.

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The police arrived quickly. Liang Shi had already been standing to the side waiting, and had even instructed Ling Dang and Sheng Yu to go home with Xu Qingzhu and get some proper rest.

There was a cold, fierce edge between her brows. She only lightly patted Xu Qingzhu's shoulder without saying anything to her.

Xu Qingzhu squeezed her palm and said in a low voice, "Then I'll wait for you at home."

"Okay." Liang Shi responded coolly.

She stood in front of Xu Qingzhu and the two children, her back straight, her brown curly hair gleaming under the office lights.

Dr. Han, not wanting to get caught up in everything, took her white coat and went directly to the ward.

Shen Hui just stood there watching them finish.

To be precise, it was Liang Shi's one-sided "assault." The woman had said "I'm sorry, let me go" more than a dozen times.

But Liang Shi only struck occasionally, and she controlled her strength. From Shen Hui's perspective, during the injury examination it would probably be classified as minor.

But it would hurt for a long time.

So Shen Hui didn't intervene.

When the police arrived, Liang Shi took the initiative to admit her wrongdoing with a cooperative attitude. The woman finally came back to her senses and, as if she had found a place to seek justice, began crying and complaining. But the police officer said, "Alright, come with us."

"Officer, I'm the victim here! Look at what she did to me! She's a lunatic!" the woman said.

Liang Shi's expression was indifferent, her emotions unreadable.

The police officer stood there and frowned. "Where are you injured?"

Apart from the slap mark on her face being somewhat obvious, no other wounds could be seen at all.

"My waist, my legs!" the woman shouted. "There will definitely be lasting effects! Officer, she knowingly broke the law....."

"We'll talk about that later." The police officer said. "First, come back to the station with us. We'll get a detailed understanding of the situation there."

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And so, in the middle of the night, Liang Shi, Shen Hui, and that woman were all taken away together.

Because there were two pitiful little children, Xu Qingzhu didn't follow along and was sent home.

The main thing was that Liang Shi took all the responsibility upon herself, while Shen Hui, as an important eyewitness, also had to go along.

After they left, Ling Dang asked Xu Qingzhu fearfully, "Aunt-Mother, will Auntie be okay?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded. "She will."

Sheng Yu huffed softly. "Of course! The police punish bad people and protect good people. My sister is a good person!"

Xu Qingzhu didn't have any particular concerns. Since Liang Shi dared to do it, it meant she was confident.

She just needed to take care of these two little ones.

Holding one in each hand, she was about to leave when she ran into Dr. Han returning to the office.

Xu Qingzhu had the two children sit in a row. Before she could even ask Dr. Han any questions, Dr. Han took off her mask and said, "Huh? It's finally over here?"

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"I'm sorry for causing you trouble." Xu Qingzhu lowered her eyes and apologized sincerely.

Dr. Han waved her hand. "It's fine. Xu Tong's mother is quite annoying. She had that son of hers when she was almost forty. Whenever she comes to the hospital and the nurses give her son an injection that's even slightly harder than usual, she starts cursing at people."

So seeing someone teach her a lesson was secretly satisfying.

She just couldn't show it on her face.

Xu Qingzhu immediately caught the key phrase in her words. "Does her son come to the hospital often?"

"Yeah." Dr. Han said. "About once a month. He was a premature baby, so his body is weak. Whenever the weather changes, he easily gets headaches and fevers."

"Has the child's fever gone down?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

"We gave him an injection." Dr. Han said. "He should be fine after tonight."

"Is there anyone looking after the child in his room right now?" Xu Qingzhu asked again.

Dr. Han said, "The child's father is there. That man is quiet and meek—he can't stand up to that woman."

He didn't even react when he heard his wife getting into a fight with someone in the office. When Dr. Han was leaving, the man had just said, "Doctor, could you tell her to stop making a fuss and come back?"

Dr. Han smiled bitterly. "That's not something I can help with."

The man only said sorry, then sat by the child's hospital bed staring into space.

Xu Qingzhu asked Dr. Han to watch the children for a moment while she went to visit Xu Tong's room.

Xu Tong was two years old. After getting his injection, he had fallen fast asleep.

As the best children's ward in Haizhou City, and because they were worried that if children cried in the middle of the night they would wake other kids, all the rooms here were private. Correspondingly, the fees were also higher.

When Xu Qingzhu arrived, the man was still sitting beside Xu Tong's bed, staring at Xu Tong's face in a daze, looking somewhat wooden.

Xu Qingzhu knocked on the door. The man slowly turned his head. Seeing it was someone he didn't recognize, he thought she had come to the wrong room. "Who are you?"

"Hello, you're Xu Tong's father, right?" Xu Qingzhu asked politely.

The man paused for two seconds before nodding. "What is it?"

"I'm Liang Wenxuan's aunt-by-marriage." Xu Qingzhu introduced herself. "I happened to bring my younger sister here to get bandaged up, and I heard that Xu Tong was also at this hospital, so I came to visit. Is the child doing okay now?"

The man was blank for a moment, then belatedly answered, "Oh, he's fine."

Xu Qingzhu's tone was relieved. "That's good then."

Then she sighed. "I'm really sorry. My wife called the police in the office just now. Your wife, my wife, and Dr. Shen have all gone to the police station."

Upon hearing this, the man froze, then furrowed his brow tightly. His lips moved slightly, very quickly—it was impossible to see clearly what he mumbled.

"What did you say?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

The man shook his head and started trying to get her to leave. "Nothing. Is there anything else? If not, please leave. I need to rest."

Xu Qingzhu paused for a moment, then said, "I heard from the doctor that Xu Tong was a premature baby? He comes to the hospital often. Do you have enough money for the medical expenses? If not, we can help cover them—please don't be polite about it. Also, may I ask why you took Xu Tong to the supermarket yesterday?"

The man was taken aback. "What's it to you? Alright, leave, leave. I don't want to see anyone from your family."

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Xu Qingzhu returned to Dr. Han to pick up the two children and asked a bit more about Xu Tong's situation.

Xu Tong was a premature baby with a weak constitution. He came to the hospital every few days for injections and IV drips. His parents were ordinary working-class people. Although they had medical insurance for reimbursement, 80% of Xu Tong's medications couldn't be reimbursed, so it was like a bottomless pit.

They had already defaulted on their medical bills once before.

Xu Tong was actually quite a well-behaved child—it was just that his mother spoiled him too much. Almost none of the nurses at the hospital dared to give him injections. Even the experienced head nurse was unwilling. Every time anyone gave Xu Tong an injection, they inevitably got berated by Xu Tong's mother until they felt utterly humiliated.

It was fortunate that the doctors and nurses had good tempers. In any other profession, who would put up with her attitude?

Xu Qingzhu also learned from Dr. Han that Xu Tong had somewhat flat feet, so he didn't walk very steadily and often tripped and fell on flat ground. But for a child his age, this was considered normal. A proper diagnosis would have to wait until he was a bit older.

On the way back, Xu Qingzhu was lost in thought.

The two children had originally been worried about Liang Shi, but after Xu Qingzhu's reassurance, they felt at ease. Before long, they fell asleep in the car.

When they got home, Xu Qingzhu couldn't carry them both, so she could only wake them up and have them go upstairs to sleep.

Ling Dang and Sheng Yu rubbed their drowsy eyes and yawned as they followed Xu Qingzhu upstairs.

When they got home, it was Rainbow who opened the door. The little girl frowned and asked how things went.

This was the first time Xu Qingzhu had experienced a scene like this—someone waiting at home for her while she held children's hands. It felt quite warm.

She had Rainbow go open the door to the second bedroom. Sheng Yu said in a voice heavy with sleepiness, "Of course everything's fine. I'm amazing, after all."

Rainbow: "....."

Sheng Yu and Ling Dang closed their eyes again the moment they touched the bed. Xu Qingzhu helped them take off their clothes, leaving them in just their undershirts and underwear.

Children's skin was so soft and tender. Picking them up, they were so small. While helping Sheng Yu undress, Sheng Yu lifted her arms, and when she lowered them, she wrapped them around Xu Qingzhu, nuzzling into the crook of her shoulder, making it a bit ticklish.

After Xu Qingzhu finished, she had Rainbow get into bed to sleep too.

Rainbow slept on the outermost side, Sheng Yu in the middle, and Ling Dang on the other side.

When Xu Qingzhu was about to leave, Rainbow held onto her and asked where Liang Shi had gone, just like a little adult.

Faced with this question, Xu Qingzhu said, "She went to uphold justice."

Rainbow: "?"

"Something came up, and she went to take care of it." Xu Qingzhu coaxed her. "Go to sleep. When you wake up tomorrow morning, you'll see your Sister Liang."

Only then did Rainbow nod obediently and close her eyes.

Looking at Rainbow's well-behaved little face, Xu Qingzhu's heart melted completely.

She couldn't help but lean in and kiss Rainbow's forehead.

Rainbow opened her eyes again. Her eyes were sparkling bright, and her voice was softer than usual. "Sister Xu~"

Xu Qingzhu patted her back. "Sleep now. Good night."

Rainbow pressed her lips together, her eyes blinking. Before closing them, she leaned over to Xu Qingzhu's cheek and gave her a kiss, then said with a smile, "Good night, Sister Xu~"

Xu Qingzhu turned off the light in the room.

The children's world sank into colorful dreams.

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Xu Qingzhu wasn't the type to keep things from Su Yao out of fear of worrying her.

On the contrary, when Su Yao asked, she poured everything out like beans from a bamboo tube. Though she simplified many details, she summarized things concisely. Then she speculated, "She should be released after they finish taking her statement."

Su Yao was stunned for a moment and said in disbelief, "Ah Shi can actually hit people?"

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"I hit someone too." Xu Qingzhu said. "That person's mouth was too foul."

She had called Ling Dang a "little wretch" and called Sheng Yu a "little mutt."

Then what did that make her?

Directly insulting her entire family—Xu Qingzhu couldn't tolerate that either.

She even somewhat regretted not going over to kick the woman a few times when Liang Shi had her pinned to the ground.

She had missed her chance.

"You can hit people too?" Su Yao asked haltingly, then followed up with, "Did you get hurt?"

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"No." Xu Qingzhu felt a warmth in her heart. "Liang Shi is quite capable. We're both fine."

Su Yao nodded. "That's good then."

Xu Qingzhu went to the kitchen to heat up two cups of milk, then returned to the master bedroom with Su Yao and handed one cup to her.

Then she leaned against the bed in the master bedroom and checked the time—it was almost midnight.

She had originally wanted to send Sun Meirou a message to let her know, but then she thought that Sun Meirou probably couldn't make any decisions in that household anyway. Better not to add to her troubles.

She would wait until things were investigated clearly before saying anything. They would see each other again when dropping off Ling Dang anyway.

Now that Liang Shi had escalated things with the other party to the police station, this matter had definitely blown up. They might as well take advantage of the chaos to fish in troubled waters¹.

There was definitely something wrong with Xu Tong and his parents. As for what connection Liang Xinran had to all this—that was uncertain.

Why did Liang Xinran suddenly want to take Ling Dang to the supermarket?

After going there, they bumped into Xu Tong, and then Xu Tong just happened to be hospitalized again.

No matter how Xu Qingzhu looked at it, it seemed like a pig-butcherer scam²—specifically designed to extort money.

It was also possible that Liang Xinran just had bad luck. Taking Ling Dang out was well-intentioned, but they happened to run into scammers.

But it was also possible that Liang Xinran was working together with them.

From a subjective standpoint, Xu Qingzhu leaned toward the second possibility. But in terms of likelihood, it should be the first.

Liang Xinran had only been in Haizhou City for about a week. How could she possibly have teamed up with them to run a pig-butcherer scam?

But what could be confirmed was that Xu Tong's family was indeed engaged in extortion.

Footnotes:

¹ **Fish in troubled waters (渾水摸魚):** A Chinese idiom meaning to take advantage of a chaotic situation to gain benefits, similar to the English expression "fishing in troubled waters."

² **Pig-butcherer scam (殺豬盤):** A type of scam originating from Chinese internet slang. The term literally means "pig-butcherer plate/scheme." It originally referred to romance scams where victims are "fattened up" (cultivated with trust) before being "slaughtered" (scammed for money). Here, it's used more broadly to refer to a scheme where someone deliberately creates a situation to extort money from victims.

Chapter 97-4

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Liang Shi and Shen Hui both spent the night at the police station, along with the victim.

After the three of them went in to give their statements, Liang Shi explained her "criminal process" with clear logic and a cooperative attitude. The police officers were quite bewildered.

The thing was, her account didn't match the victim's. The victim claimed that Liang Shi had definitely beaten her until she was bruised and such.

Shen Hui's bystander testimony was even more straightforward. Liang Shi had definitely hit her, but she didn't know how hard. She had wanted to intervene, but before she could, Liang Shi had already finished the fight. Her movements were very fast.

Shen Hui said she felt quite helpless about it too.

In the end, they could only do an injury examination. After waiting all night, the results came back as minor injury—not even close to meeting the standard for criminal charges, let alone detention.

For this kind of civil dispute, both sides were encouraged to settle privately.

The officers did ideological work with them all night. Liang Shi was very cooperative and willing to accept any outcome.

The victim was in a daze for a long time. After staying up all night, she finally couldn't hold out anymore and agreed to settle.

So Liang Shi compensated her three thousand yuan and signed a settlement agreement. But she still needed someone to come pick her up and pay the fine.

Liang Shi reasonably suspected that this rule existed just to publicly humiliate her.

At six in the morning, dawn had just broken, and the distant eastern sky was showing the pale light of fish belly white¹.

Liang Shi scrolled through her contacts. She didn't call Xu Qingzhu, but called Liang Xinhe instead. Liang Xinhe didn't answer.

Looking at Shen Hui who was still signing paperwork, Liang Shi called Zhao Xuning directly.

Zhao Xuning, who kept a good sleep schedule, answered immediately, though she still had a hint of morning grumpiness. Her tone was unfriendly. "This better be important."

"Come pick me up at the police station." Liang Shi said. "Your ex-girlfriend is here too."

Zhao Xuning was jolted awake and became even more agitated. "What happened?"

But rustling sounds could already be heard on the other end, like she was getting dressed.

Liang Shi said, "I hit someone....."

"You f***ing hit Shen Hui? Are you crazy?" Zhao Xuning said through gritted teeth. "Just wait....."

Liang Shi: "....."

She suspected Zhao Xuning's next words would be—I'm coming with a knife.

Liang Shi quickly explained, "No, no, how could I hit your beloved ex-girlfriend? Your ex-girlfriend is a witness. She's been at the police station with me all night. I need someone to come pay the fine and take me away."

Zhao Xuning: ".....Where?"

After Liang Shi told her, she stood there waiting. She had only slept a little over two hours the whole night, but she wasn't tired now.

Probably because it was her first time getting into a fight and ending up at the police station—it was quite a novel experience.

All night she had been thinking—She actually had a day like this?

If Sister Wang and her assistant Xiao Bai saw this, they would definitely be overjoyed and praise her for finally toughening up.

Actually, at the time, Liang Shi hadn't thought about the consequences. She was just annoyed by that person.

No matter what, you can't speak so rudely to children.

Before long, Liang Xinhe replied to her message: 【What's up?】

Liang Shi: 【Nothing now. Why are you up so early?】

Liang Xinhe: 【I never went to sleep!】

A few seconds later, a voice message came through. Even through the screen, you could hear his anger. "I'm at the hospital. I'm about to explode. That Liang Xinran, she..... I..... I'm really going to explode from anger!"

Liang Shi: "....."

She didn't want to get involved, but since Liang Xinhe had already said this much, she could only follow up with a question: 【What happened?】

A long voice message from Liang Xinhe came through. Even through the screen, his anger was palpable. "I went home last night to confront them, but Mom just took Liang Xinran's side. I just asked Liang Xinran a few questions—asked her why she wanted to take Ling Dang out, asked her why she apologized on my daughter's behalf when Ling Dang didn't even admit to doing anything wrong. Ling Dang has grown up this big and I've never been willing to lay a finger on her. And then, I just spend a few days at the company, and this is what happens at home. I'm f***ing furious!"

"I didn't even curse at anyone—I just asked her a few questions. And then! She fainted. I'm truly impressed. Didn't she grow up in the countryside? My Ling Dang didn't faint when they were pointing at her nose and scolding her, but she did..... I'm so pissed."

"Liang Shi, let me tell you, I finally understand why Big Brother was so decisive back then. This person coming back is nothing but a disaster. I got hit too! Mom has gone crazy—she's turned against her own family for her. Before, Mom spoiled you, sure, but she never did anything like this for you. Now she's really gone mad. What Sister-in-law said when she left home was absolutely right—she's been bewitched by Liang Xinran!"

Liang Xinhe's voice messages were especially long. He was so angry that his voice was shaking. But Liang Shi managed to piece together a thread from his rage-filled words.

Footnotes:

¹ **Fish belly white (魚肚白):** A Chinese expression describing the pale, grayish-white color of the sky at dawn, resembling the pale underbelly of a fish. It's a common literary way to describe the early morning sky just before sunrise.

Chapter 97-5

Liang Xinhe had gone home last night to confront Liang Xinran, but Qiu Zimin had protected her. Liang Xinhe ended up getting hit by Qiu Zimin too.

Listening to this, Liang Shi felt a mix of emotions. She thought Qiu Zimin had truly gone insane.

Her daughter was her biological child, but wasn't her son also her own flesh and blood?

When the whole world is trying to stop you, shouldn't you reflect on yourself a little?

But Qiu Zimin didn't reflect. She chose to go against the whole world.

The result was that Liang Xinran fainted, and Qiu Zimin was so angry that her chest hurt—she was hospitalized.

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What a drama this was.

After listening to his voice messages, Liang Shi sent an "okay" emoji.

Then she told him to calm down.

Liang Xinhe didn't reply after that—he had probably gone off to deal with things.

She hadn't been standing there waiting long when Shen Hui finished signing and came out. She didn't need anyone to pick her up and could leave directly.

As she passed by Liang Shi, she didn't even spare her a glance and walked straight ahead. But Liang Shi called out to stop her. "Dr. Shen, wait a moment."

Shen Hui stopped in her tracks but didn't turn around. She said coldly, "What is it?"

Liang Shi walked over and apologized to her gently. "I'm really sorry about last night. I didn't expect things to develop like this either. I've caused you trouble."

"You didn't give me any heads up before you hit someone." Shen Hui's light brown pupils swept across her face, indifferent and cold. "Don't you think it's a bit late to say this now?"

Liang Shi: ".....I'm really sorry. Desperate times call for desperate measures. Can I treat you to breakfast as an apology?"

Shen Hui: "No need. Just don't come to our hospital again."

Liang Shi: "....."

Having hit a soft wall, Liang Shi awkwardly touched the tip of her nose and asked seriously and politely, "Dr. Shen, may I ask why you dislike me?"

"Hm?" Shen Hui looked at her. "I dislike you?"

Liang Shi nodded. "Yes. I've sensed it since last night. You seem to be..... hostile toward me."

"You're imagining it." Shen Hui said. "The truth is, I look down on you."

Liang Shi: "?"

"This is our first time meeting, isn't it?" Liang Shi said. "Why would you say that?"

"A married person being involved with someone else in an unclear relationship." Shen Hui laughed contemptuously. "Does your wife know?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"I'm not!" Liang Shi said. "Who am I supposedly involved with? Dr. Shen, you can't just falsely accuse....."

"Shen Hui." Zhao Xuning suddenly interrupted her.

She came running against the faint morning light. Shen Hui's light brown pupils only gave her a brief, shallow glance. Then, as Zhao Xuning ran over, she took a step back to maintain distance, her hands stuffed in her trench coat pockets, appearing utterly cold and distant.

Zhao Xuning asked anxiously, "Are you okay?"

Shen Hui said coolly, "Why don't you go care about the person you should be caring about."

Zhao Xuning frowned. "Huh?"

Shen Hui lifted her chin toward Liang Shi. "I'm not the one who called you here. What do you want with me? Dr. Zhao, hanging around with a married woman—how impressive of you."

Zhao Xuning: "?"

Shen Hui laughed lightly, her eyes devoid of warmth. "Sorry, I forgot—Dr. Zhao has never had any boundaries."

Liang Shi & Zhao Xuning: "....."

Liang Shi now understood where her inexplicable hostility came from.

Just as Zhao Xuning was about to deny it, Liang Shi suddenly stepped forward and clung to Zhao Xuning's arm. "Oh my, Dr. Shen, so that's what you were talking about? My wife and I are in a lavender marriage¹. Dr. Zhao is my true love."

Zhao Xuning: "?"

Footnotes:

¹ **Lavender marriage (形婚):** Short for "形式婚姻" (xíngshì hūnyīn), literally "formal marriage" or "marriage in form only." This refers to a marriage of convenience, typically between a gay man and a lesbian woman, entered into for social appearances while both parties maintain their actual romantic relationships separately. It's a way for LGBTQ+ individuals to satisfy family and societal expectations in cultures where same-sex relationships are not widely accepted.